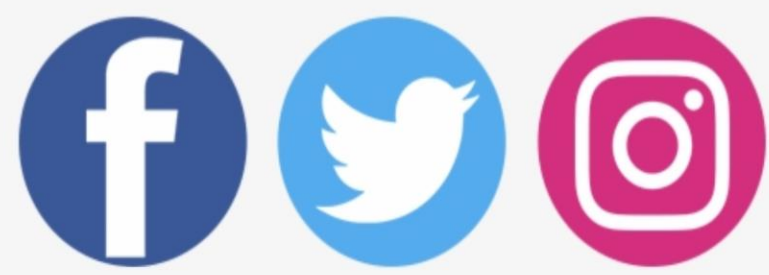
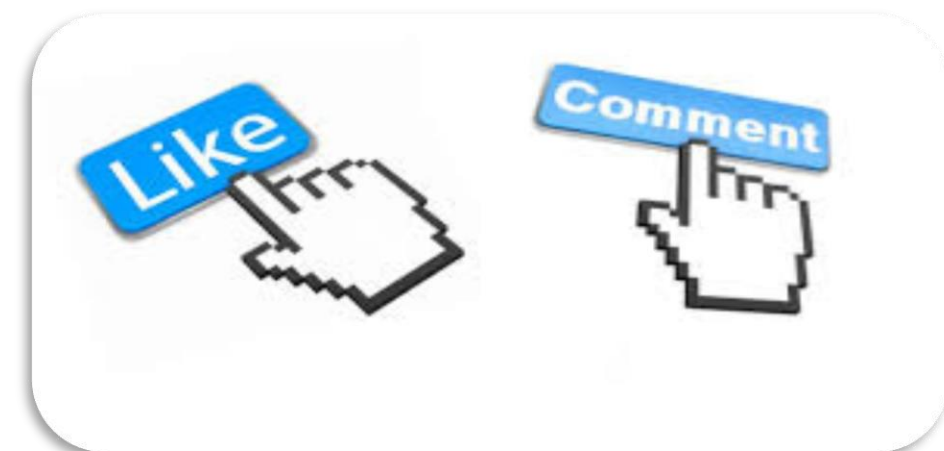


Gathering Other-Regarding Preferences Using Social Media Behaviour



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Main Research Question:

- Is it possible to gather Trust and Reciprocity preferences using social media behaviour?

Secondary Research Questions:

- Are there behavioural differences between the different social media platforms?
- What effect does age have on prosocial behaviour?

Methodology:

➤ Survey

- Contained questions relating to other-regarding preferences and common choices found in a social media environment
- The survey was divided into three sections; Facebook, Instagram and Twitter
- Participants were only required to answer one of the sections based on their most commonly used social medium

➤ Trust Game: Berg et al. (1995)

- Participants in the study played the role of both 'Sender' and 'Receiver' via allocation of a random 'Sender' and 'Receiver' number
- The 'Sender' is endowed with R100 and then decides what portion (if any) of the money to send to the 'Receiver'
- The 'Receiver' receives triple the sent amount and then decides what portion (if any) of the tripled amount to send back to the 'Sender'.
- Sent amounts are interpreted as indicating trust while returned amounts are interpreted as indicating reciprocity
- At the end of the game, five random 'Sender' or 'Receiver' numbers were drawn to be compensated in real money based on their trust game responses

➤ Sample:

- 233 students from the University of Pretoria were recruited to participate in the study (197 first years and 69 third years)
- Participation was completely voluntary

Results: Significant = ✓

➤ Tobit Regression Results - Trust

Variable	Combined	Facebook	Instagram	Twitter
NotClosely Comment		✓*	✓**	
Income Above				✓***
EthnicityB	✓**	✓*	✓**	
Prob>chi2			✓*	✓**

* p<.10, ** p<.05, *** p<0.01

➤ Tobit Regression Results – Reciprocity

Variable	Combined	Facebook	Instagram	Twitter
NotLike Recent	✓*			
Always Liked		✓**		
EthnicityB			✓**	
AgeOlder		✓**		
Prob>chi2		✓*		

* p<.10, ** p<.05, *** p<0.01

Conclusion:

- There are behavioural differences between the different social media platforms
- It was not possible to conclude that the aspects of social media that was measured can be used as substitutes for trust and reciprocity as measured in a trust game
- It is possible that aspects of social media behaviour, other than the ones used in this study, could be used to predict behaviour outside of social media